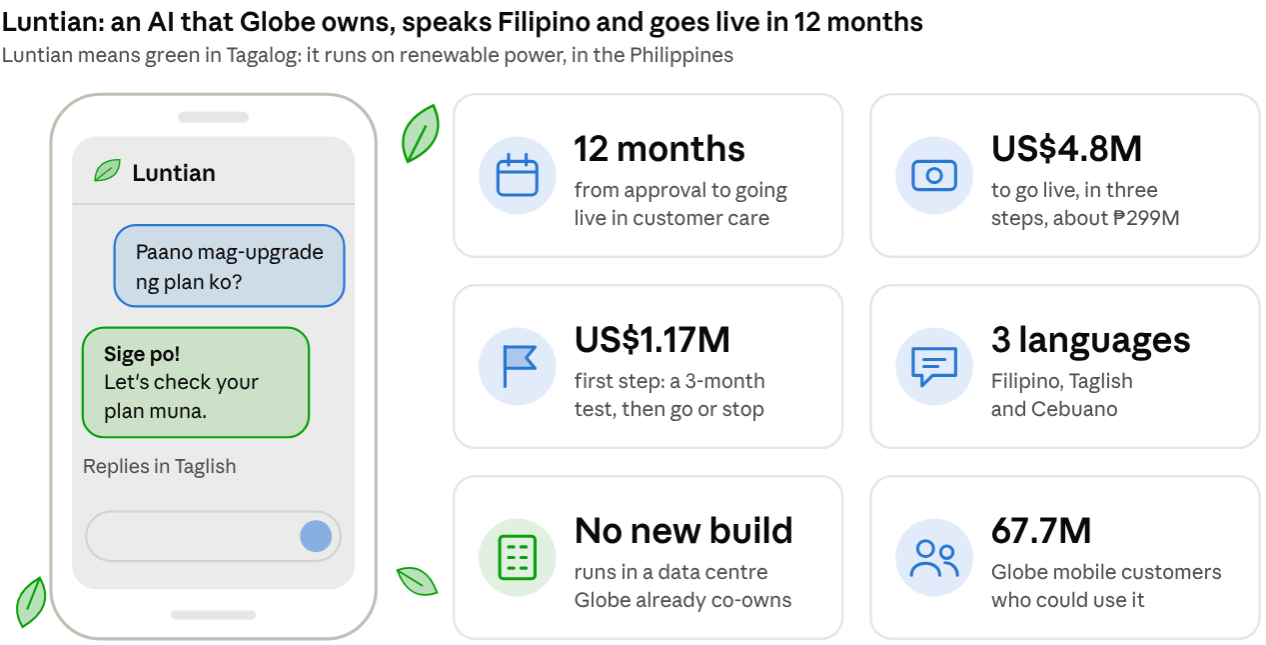
Project Luntian: The Proposal in Plain Words

Independent proposal, revised November 2026

This is the Project Luntian proposal for Globe Telecom, in plain words and pictures. This version starts small: Globe spends US$1.17M on a 3-month test first, and about US$4.8M in total to go live in customer care. It takes about 10 minutes to read.



Project Luntian at a glance: six key numbers

In short: Globe adapts a free, open AI model to Filipino, runs it in a data centre it already co-owns, and pays in three steps, each only after a yes at a checkpoint. Anything more is added only when it pays. The companion report, Project Luntian: How We Do It, Step by Step, explains every task in detail for this same smaller start.

For a quick look first, the one-page website Project Luntian tells the same story as a comic in about five minutes.

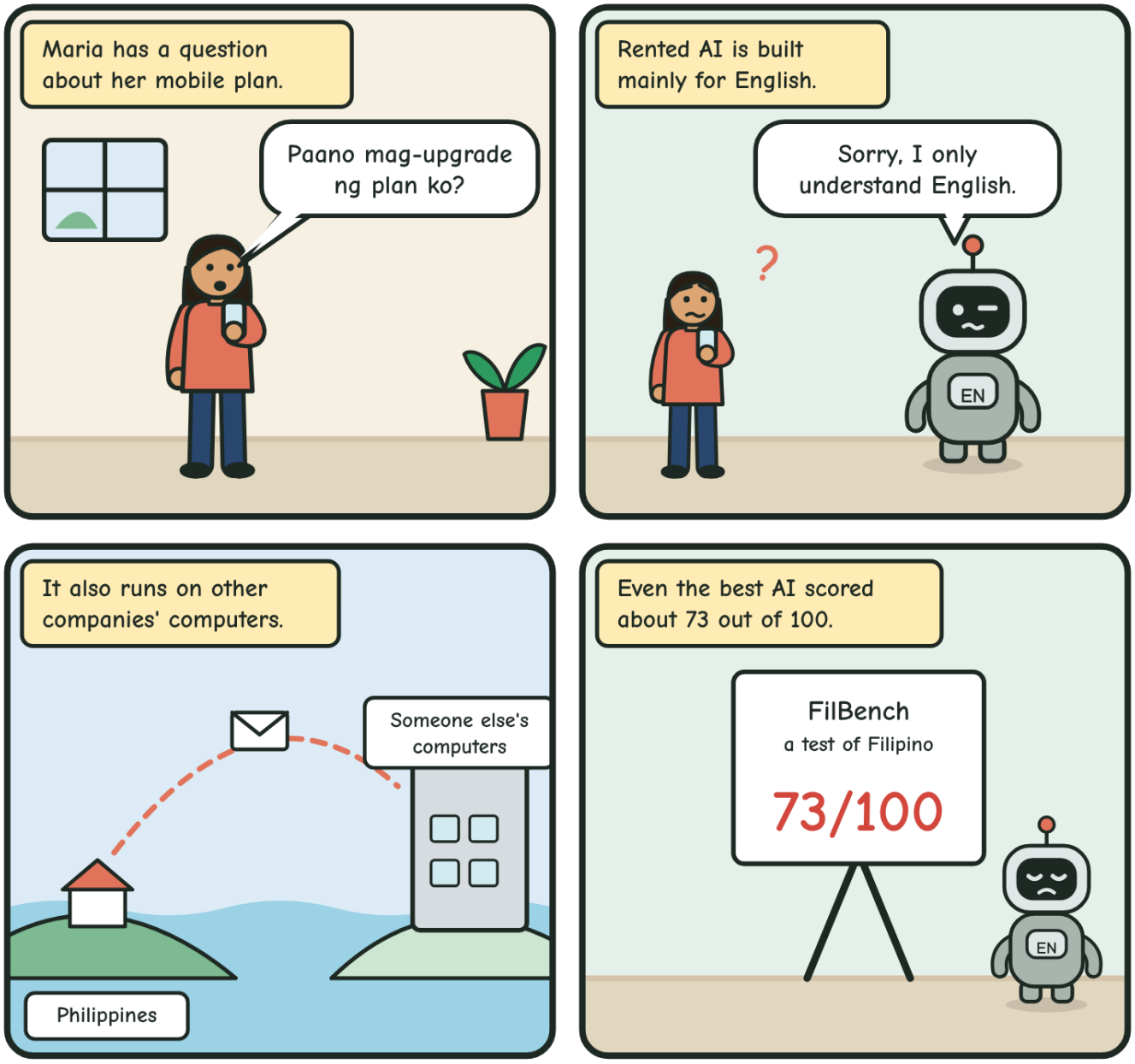
1. The short answers

This version answers four questions from the first review.

Question	Short answer
Can Globe start with less?	Yes. The first commitment is US$1.17M (₱73M) for a 3-month test. Going live in customer care costs about US$4.8M (₱299M) in total, released in three steps. The first two years cost about US$7.5M, about half of the earlier US$14.4M plan, and anything more is added only when it pays.
What does each part cost, and why?	About 40% of the money pays for the people who build and run Luntian, and only about a sixth pays for computing. Every line in section 4 shows what it buys. People and computing are priced from units and rates; the rest are upper-side allowances until suppliers quote.
Can Globe use a data centre it already has?	Yes. Nothing new is built. Luntian runs on one rented server in a small locked space at STT GDC Philippines, the data centre company Globe co-owns. The 3-month test needs no space of its own, because it runs on rented machines.
When does Globe get its money back?	On customer care and staff savings alone, at month 50: about 3 years after going live, or just over 4 years after approval. If Globe Business also sells Luntian to 10 to 20 business clients, at month 33 to 39, which is 21 to 27 months after going live.

2. The idea in one minute

Globe should own an AI that speaks Filipino, Taglish and Cebuano, run it on green power in the Philippines, and start with a small test before spending more.

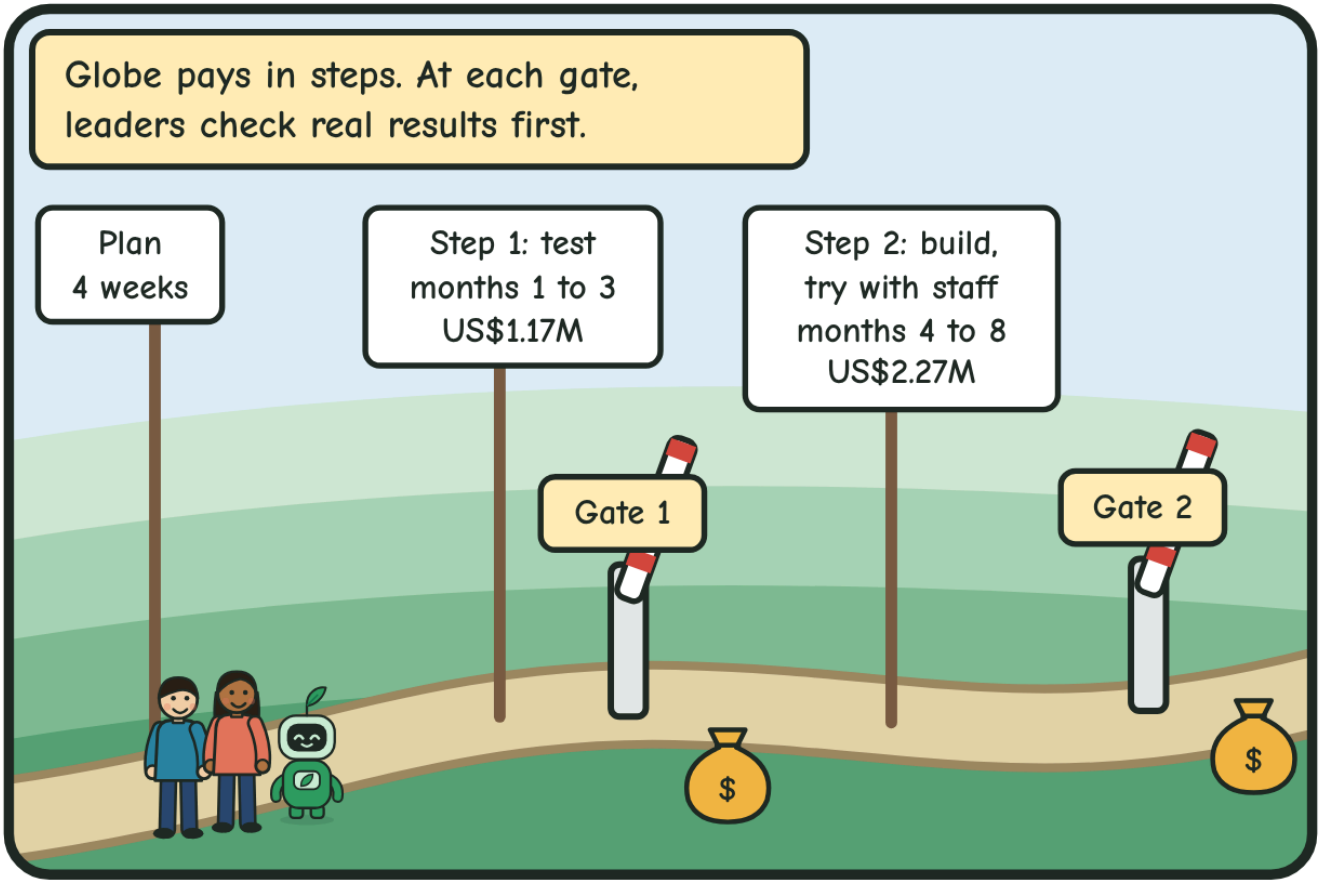


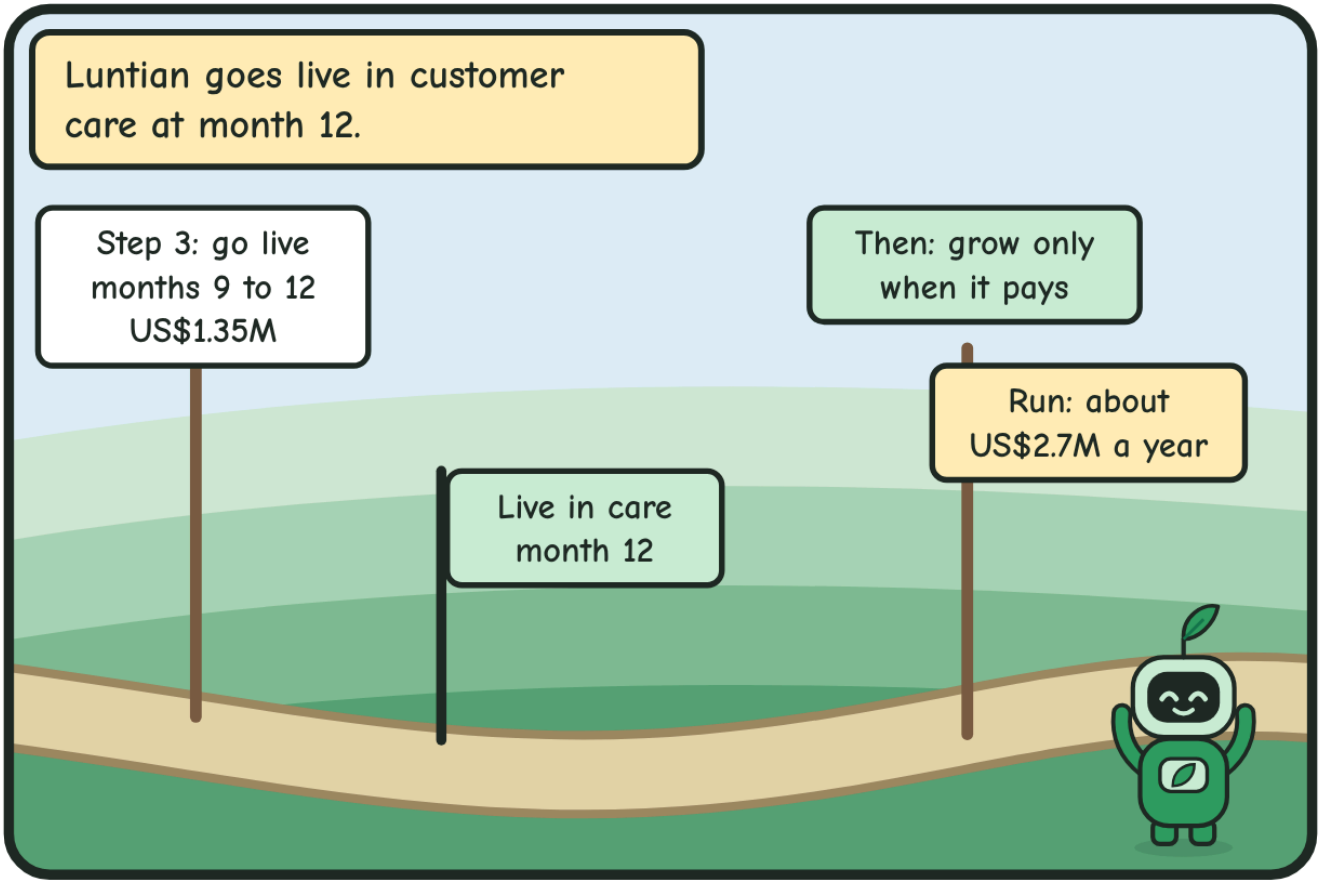
Question	Answer
What is it?	Luntian, Globe's own AI. Luntian means "green" in Tagalog.
Why does Globe need it?	Today's popular AI tools are built mainly for English. On FilBench, a 2025 test of Filipino, the best model scored about 73 out of 100. Rented AI also runs on other companies' computers, often outside the Philippines.
How does Globe get it?	Globe takes a free, open AI model and trains it on Filipino and on Globe's own work. It is like hiring a bright graduate and training them, instead of raising someone from birth.

Question	Answer
What does Globe get?	Faster, cheaper customer care in the customer's own language, a private assistant for Globe staff and, later, an AI product Globe Business can sell to banks, hospitals and government. Globe owns and controls all of it.
What is the risk?	Limited by the gates: US$1.17M if the test fails, or about US$3.4M if the staff trial fails. Either way, Globe keeps what was built.

3. Start small, then grow

Luntian goes live in three steps. Before Step 1, a 4-week planning study confirms the uses, the data, the partners and the budget (section 9). After Steps 1 and 2, Globe's leaders meet at a gate, look at real results and decide whether to release the money for the next one.


Globe pays in steps. At each gate, leaders check real results first.
Plan
4 weeks
Step 1: test
months 1 to 3
US$1.17M
Step 2: build, try with staff
months 4 to 8
US$2.27M
Gate 1
Gate 2
$
$

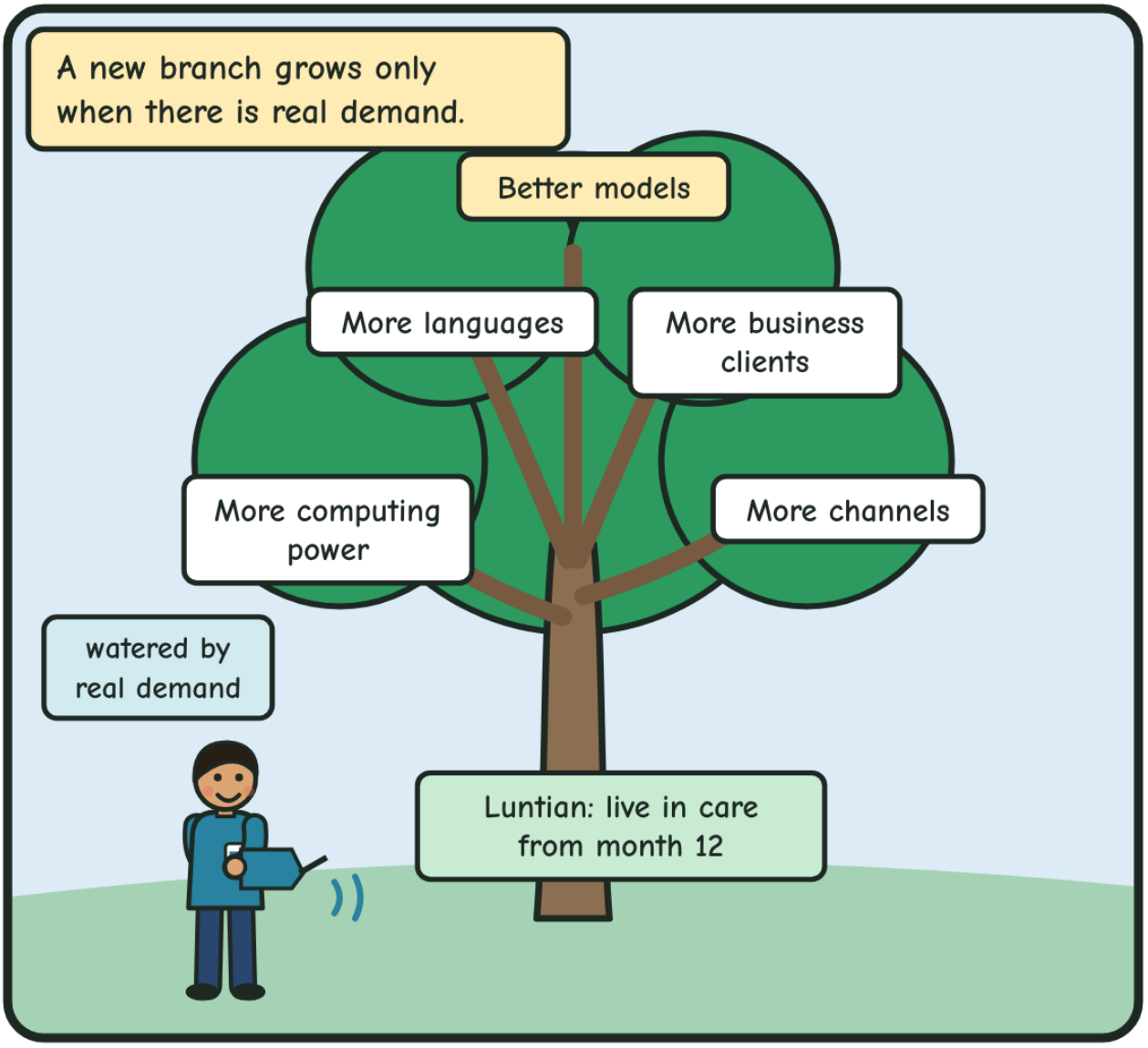

Luntian goes live in customer care at month 12.
Step 3: go live
months 9 to 12
US$1.35M
Then: grow only when it pays
Run: about
US$2.7M a year
Live in care
month 12

Step	Months	What happens	Cost	Money released
1. Test	1 to 3	Compare five or six open models on about 1,000 real Globe questions in Filipino and Taglish, check that Globe's data can be used lawfully, and run small trials	US$1.17M (₱73M)	At the start
2. Build and try with staff	4 to 8	Teach the best model Filipino, connect it to Globe's care and staff tools, and let Globe staff use it first	US$2.27M (₱142M)	Only if Gate 1 is passed, at month 3
3. Go live	9 to 12	Fix what the staff trial found, pass outside safety and security checks, and open care chat to customers, a few at a time	US$1.35M (₱84M)	Only if Gate 2 is passed, at month 8
Total to go live	**12 months**	**One Globe model in care chat, plus a staff assistant**	**US$4.79M (₱299M)**	**In three steps**

If Globe stops at a gate, it keeps everything built so far: the test questions, the data rights, the tools and what the team has learned. At Gate 1 Globe has spent US$1.17M, and at Gate 2 about US$3.4M.

After going live: grow only when it pays

From month 13, Luntian costs about US$2.7M (₱171M) a year to run and keep up to date (section 4). Everything else is an add-on. Each one starts only when its trigger is met and its own numbers show that it pays.



Add-on	Starts only when	Extra cost (upper side)
A second server (8 more GPUs)	The first server is busy more than 70% of the time for four weeks	About US$0.44M a year
Luntian for business clients	At least three banks, hospitals or agencies sign letters of intent. Each client's own servers are paid from its fees	About US$0.40M once
A standby site and ISO/IEC 42001 certification	Business clients or regulators ask for them	About US$0.28M once
Voice on the care hotline	Care chat meets its targets for three months in a row	About US$0.80M once

Add-on	Starts only when	Extra cost (upper side)
More languages: Ilocano, Hiligaynon and Waray	There is enough licensed data and the tests are good	About US$0.37M once
Scam warnings in Filipino, from a small fast model	Globe's anti-scam team asks for it and the privacy review approves it	About US$0.26M once
A large model for the hardest questions	More than 5% of questions need the outside AI backup	About US$0.32M once, plus a server

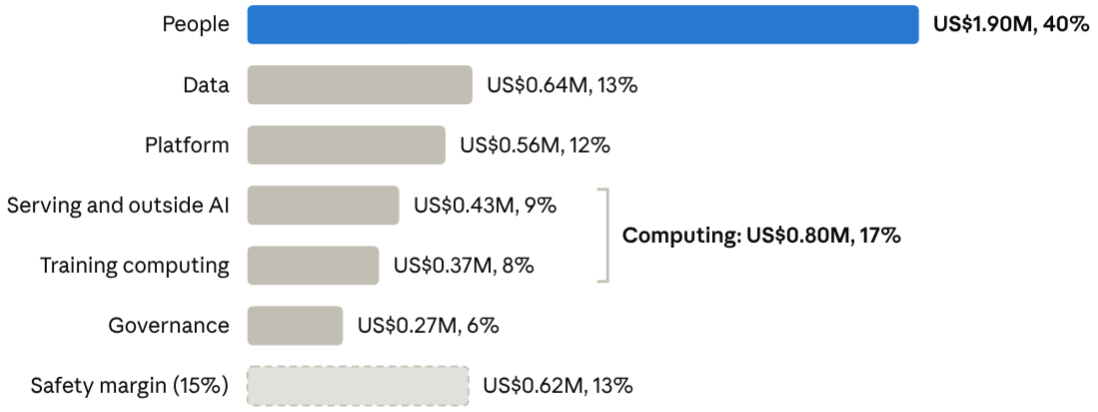
All add-on costs include the 15% safety margin. Costs marked once do not include any running cost they add later.

4. What each part costs, and why

All costs are upper-side estimates in US dollars, with a 15% safety margin on every line. Peso figures use ₱62.5 per US$ and are rounded.

Where the US$4.8M to go live goes: mostly people, and about a sixth on computing

Steps 1 to 3, months 1 to 12: US$4.79M in total, including a 15% safety margin



Upper-side prices; shares are rounded. The tables below show what each line pays for.

Proposal cost model: Steps 1 to 3, months 1 to 12, at upper-side prices

People are the biggest cost because most of the work is expert work: teaching the model, checking it and connecting it to Globe's systems. Computing is only about a sixth, because Globe adapts a model that already exists instead of building one. In the tables below, people and computing are priced from units and rates; data, platform and governance are upper-side allowances until suppliers quote.

The three steps, line by line

Line	Step 1 (US$)	Step 2 (US$)	Step 3 (US$)	What it pays for, and how it was priced
People	413,000	825,000	660,000	10 people for 3 months, then 12 people for 9 months, at US$13,750 per person per month
Training computing	62,000	248,000	62,000	10,000, then 40,000, then 10,000 GPU-hours at US$6.20 an hour. Most of Step 2 teaches the model Filipino (30,000 hours)
Serving and outside AI	100,000	181,000	148,000	Step 1: a smaller test server rented in the Philippines for the 3 months (60,000) and outside AI for comparison tests (40,000). Steps 2 and 3: one 8-GPU server at US$5.50 per GPU-hour, plus 20,000 each for outside AI as a rare backup
Data	146,000	400,000	90,000	Step 1: a privacy check of Globe's data (46,000), test questions written by Filipino linguists (60,000) and licence legal work (40,000). Step 2: licensed Filipino text from publishers and broadcasters (250,000) and worked examples written by linguists (150,000). Step 3: safety examples (50,000) and go-live test sets (40,000)

Line	Step 1 (US$)	Step 2 (US$)	Step 3 (US$)	What it pays for, and how it was priced
Platform	200,000	250,000	110,000	Step 1: tools to train and track models (120,000), a security review (40,000) and team set-up (40,000). Step 2: the gateway and router (150,000) and links to Globe's care and staff tools (100,000). Step 3: safety filters (60,000) and monitoring (50,000)
Governance	100,000	70,000	100,000	Step 1: a privacy impact assessment and legal work (50,000), a licence review of the open model (20,000) and setting up an ethics board (30,000). Step 2: regulator and legal work (50,000) and the ethics board (20,000). Step 3: an outside red-team audit (70,000) and a penetration test (30,000)
Safety margin (15%)	153,000	296,000	176,000	For price changes and surprises. If it is not needed, it is not spent
Total	**1,174,000 (₱73M)**	**2,270,000 (₱142M)**	**1,346,000 (₱84M)**	**US$4.79M (₱299M) to go live**

Each year after going live

Line	Each year (US$)	How it was worked out
People	1,320,000	8 people all year to run, improve and watch the service, at US$13,750 per person per month
Serving	386,000	One 8-GPU server all year: 8 GPUs × 8,760 hours × US$5.50, rounded up

Line	Each year (US$)	How it was worked out
Outside AI backup	60,000	Rare, very hard questions only, never with personal data
Model refresh	217,000	35,000 GPU-hours at US$6.20, for one full refresh a year, or two smaller ones
Data	150,000	New licensed text and fresh test sets
Platform	150,000	Software support and monitoring
Governance	100,000	A yearly outside audit and the ethics board
Safety margin (15%)	357,000	For price changes and surprises
Total	**2,740,000 (₱171M)**	**Well below the earlier plan's US$4.8M a year**

The prices behind every line

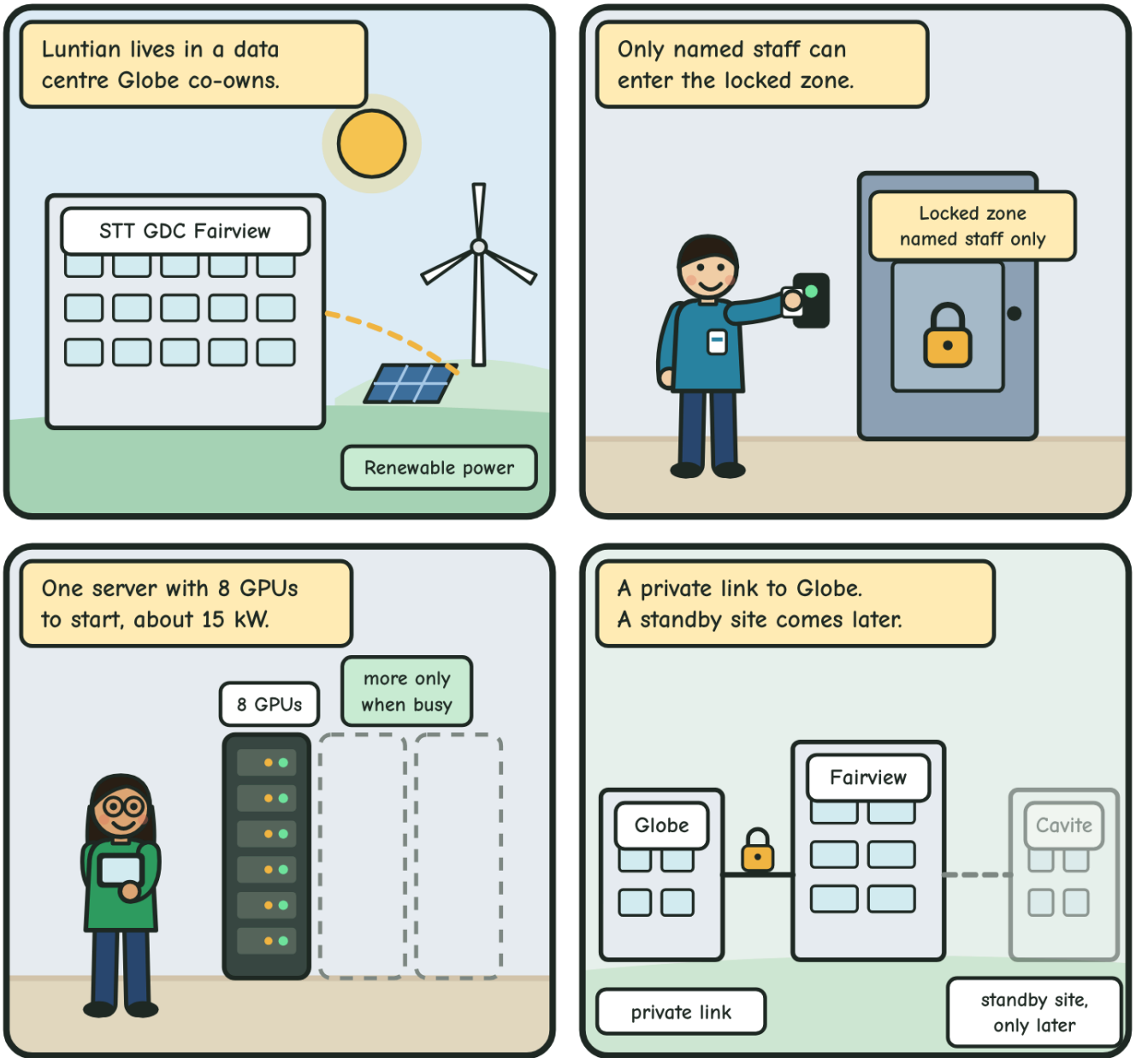
Unit	Price used	Why this price
One person for one month	US$13,750	US$165,000 a year, fully loaded: pay, benefits, hiring and partner experts. It is an upper-side blend of Manila and regional rates
One GPU for one hour, training	US$6.20	CoreWeave's on-demand list price for H100 GPUs, about US$6.16, rounded up. Newer B200 GPUs were listed at up to US$6.89 an hour in October 2026, which the 15% margin covers
One GPU for one hour, serving	US$5.50	Nebius's H100 list price of US$4.50, plus 20% for hosting in the Philippines, rounded up. It covers the server, its locked space, power and cooling, and is a planning rate until suppliers quote
Safety margin	15%	Added to every line for price changes and surprises
Exchange rate	₱62.5 per US$	The rate TelecomTV used for Globe's AI results in September 2026, to be checked against the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas rate when the budget is approved

Two ways to spend less:

- **Use Globe's own people.** If about half the team comes from Globe's AI group (AIDE) and Globe IT, new spending to go live falls from about US$4.8M to about US$3.7M, because their time is already paid for.
- **Buy the server once it is busy.** At month 12, Globe can buy the server instead of renting it. Renting costs about US$0.39M a year. Buying costs about US$0.6M plus space, power and support; if those stay under about US$0.1M a year, buying is cheaper after about two years.

5. Using what Globe already has

Globe does not build a data centre, buy a supercomputer or start an AI team from zero. Luntian uses what Globe already has and adds only what is missing.



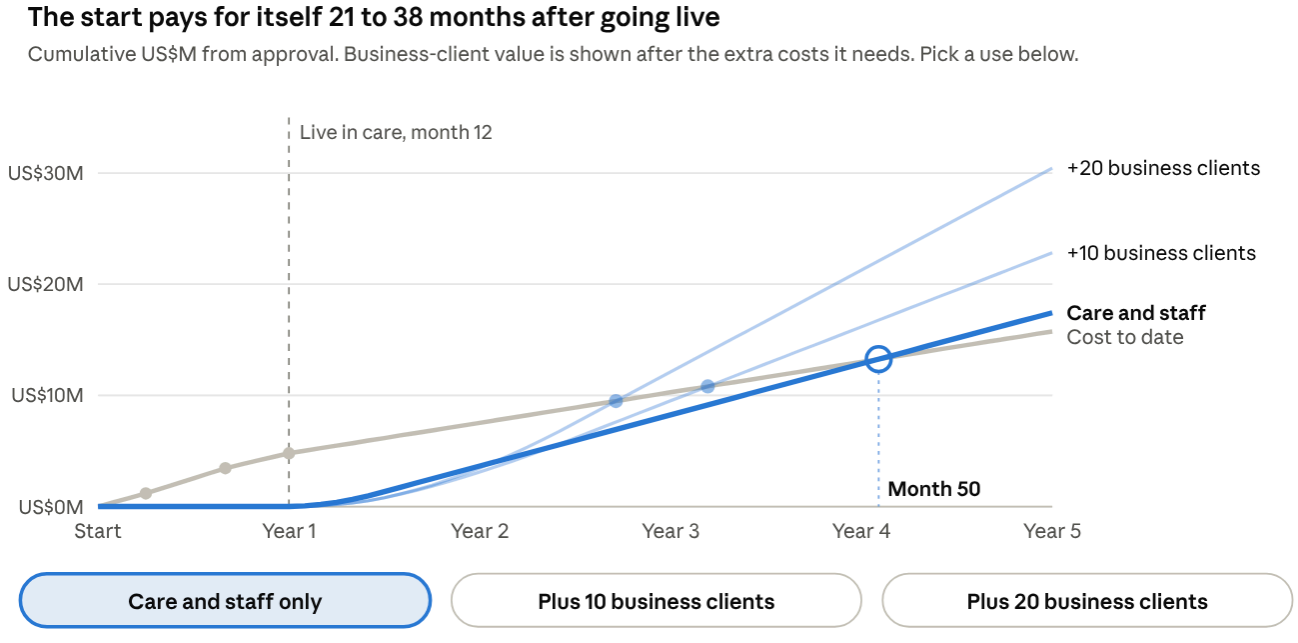
What Luntian needs	What Globe already has	How Luntian uses it
A secure home in the Philippines	STT GDC Philippines, the data centre company Globe co-owns with STT GDC and Ayala. Its Fairview campus in Quezon City runs on renewable power and is ready for AI servers	One small locked space of about 15 kW, a quarter of the 60 kW in the earlier plan. More servers are added one at a time, only when busy. The Cavite campus can be the standby site later
Computers for the test	GPU clouds that rent by the hour	Step 1 runs on rented GPUs, so nothing is bought before the idea is proven. Work that uses Globe data stays on a test server in the Philippines

What Luntian needs	What Globe already has	How Luntian uses it
People who know AI	Globe's AI group, AIDE, set up in 2024	Up to half of the 10 to 12 roles can come from AIDE and Globe IT, with partners filling the rest at first
A way to reach customers and staff	Globe's care chat, agent tools and staff systems	Luntian plugs into them. Nothing that customers see is rebuilt
Rules and checks	Globe's privacy office, cybersecurity team and responsible AI rules	Reused, so Luntian follows the same rules as the rest of Globe

Renting the space from STT GDC also keeps that part of the spending inside a company Globe co-owns.

6. When Globe gets its money back

Value starts when Luntian goes live at month 12 and builds up over the next six months. How soon the start pays for itself depends on what Luntian is used for.



Proposal cost and value model: when the start pays for itself, for three uses

On care and staff savings alone, Luntian pays back at month 50, about 3 years after going live. With 10 business clients it pays back at month 39, 27 months after going live, and with 20 at month 33, 21 months after going live. Business clients are assumed to join gradually over the year from month 19, once the business offer is set up. These two cases also pay for the business set-up (US$0.40M), the standby site and ISO/IEC 42001 (US$0.28M) and a second shared server from month 19 (US$0.44M a year).

Where the value comes from	How it works	Value a year, once running
Customer care	Luntian answers routine chats in the customer's own language and helps agents with the rest, with quality checked on every chat	About US$3.0M (₱188M)
Staff assistant	Globe staff use Luntian for sensitive work instead of paid outside AI tools	About US$1.6M (₱100M)
Business clients, later	Globe Business sells a private Luntian to banks, hospitals and agencies, at about US$500,000 of revenue per client a year and a 50% margin	About US$0.25M (₱16M) per client

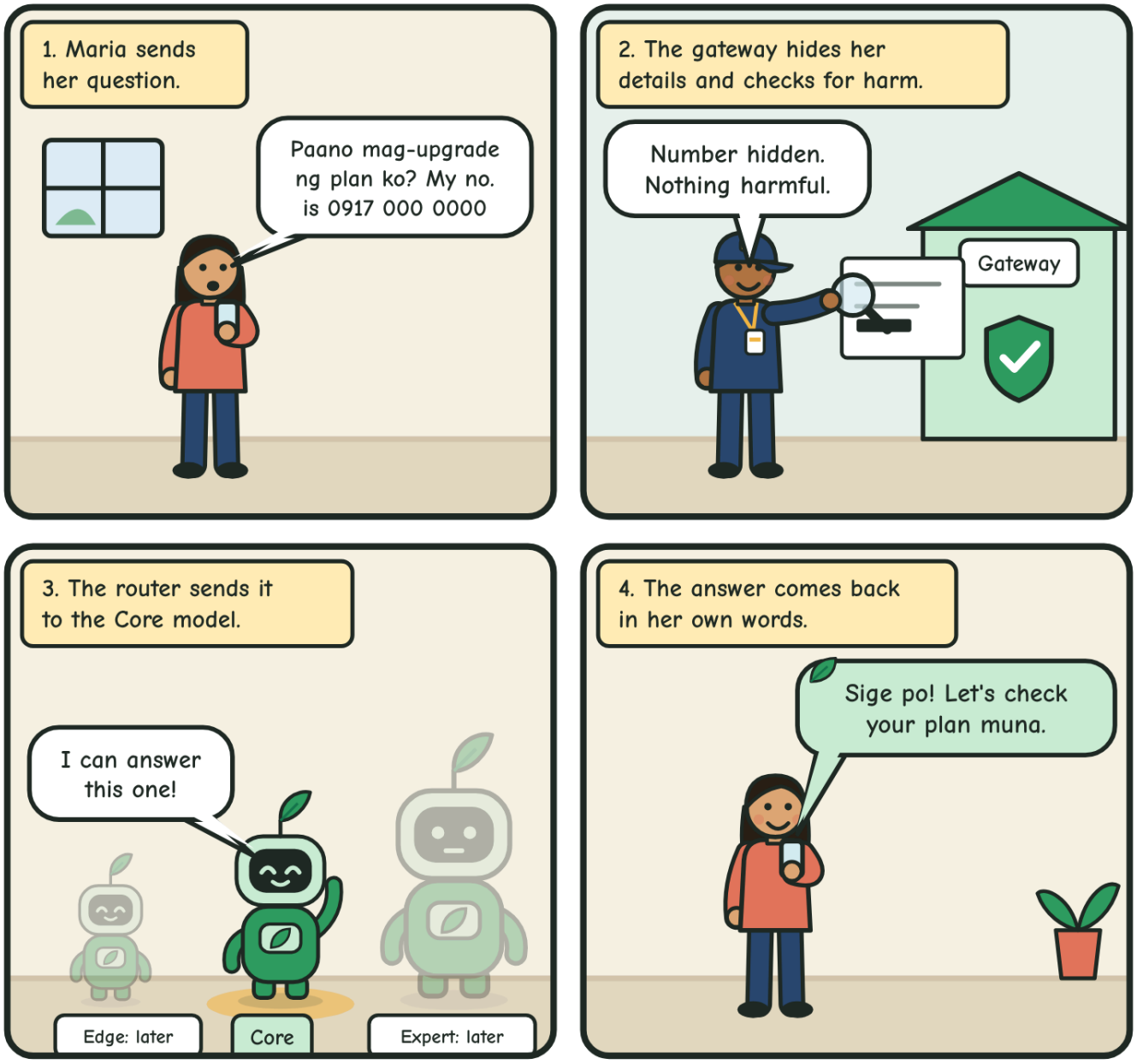
These values are planning assumptions, not yet checked against Globe's own data. Step 1 checks them against Globe's own numbers, such as contact volumes, handling times and current spending on outside AI, before any more money is released.

Two rules of thumb:

- To pay back within two years of going live, Luntian must bring about ₱360M of value a year, reached in full by month 18, with no add-ons to pay for.
- The smaller start pays back on care and staff savings alone. The earlier plan could not, because its running cost of US$4.8M a year was higher than those savings.

7. How it works and stays safe

Every question goes first through one gateway, which hides personal details and blocks harmful requests, and then to Globe's own model.



At the start there is one Globe model, the medium-sized Core model. A rented outside AI handles only the rare, very hard question, and it never sees personal data. A small fast model and a large one come later, only if they pay (section 3).

- **Personal data never leaves the Philippines.** Names, phone numbers, account numbers and addresses are hidden before training, and SIM registration records are never used.
- **Globe owns it.** The trained model, the Filipino data, the test questions and the tools belong to Globe, and partner contracts say so.
- **It is locked away.** The server sits in a locked space that only named staff can enter, with no public internet path to the model.
- **It is tested before customers see it.** Every new version is checked for quality, safety and bias, and outside experts try to break it first.
- **Care keeps working if it fails.** With one server at the start, a fault sends chats back to today's care system until it is fixed.

8. Proof it works

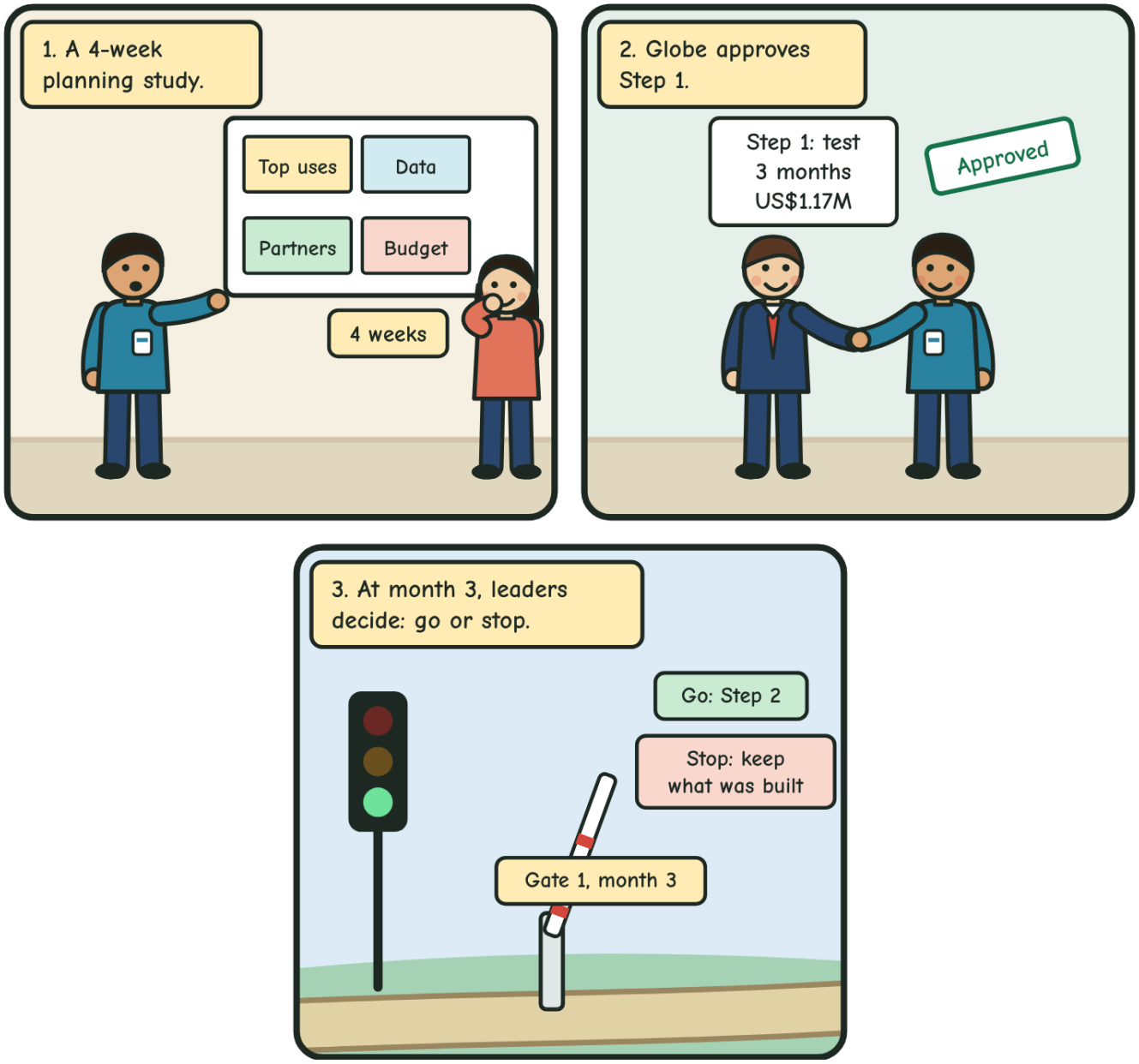
Other telecom companies have done this, and two of them started small.

Company	Country	What they did	Result
Indosat and GoTo	Indonesia	Adapted open models into Sahabat-AI, an Indonesian-language model. One version was trained in 7 days on 32 GPUs	Indosat now sells AI services to more than 20 companies
Fastweb	Italy	Started by tuning an open model on 8 GPUs, then built an Italian model with licensed data, an ethics board and an outside audit	Sells it to businesses as FastwebAI Suite
Swisscom	Switzerland	Offers Apertus, a Swiss-built open model, to its business customers	Available to business customers from launch day in September 2025
AT&T	United States	Moved routine work from a big model to small, specially trained ones	Same work at 35% of the previous cost, with 91% accuracy

The lesson: start from an open model, start small, keep it in your own country, and sell it to businesses once it works.

9. What is needed to start

Two decisions start everything, and nothing more is committed until each gate is passed.



1. **A 4-week planning study** to confirm the top uses, the data Globe can use, the partners and the budget. It ends with a Step 1 plan ready to approve. Its cost is agreed separately and is not in the US$4.79M.
2. **Approval of Step 1:** US$1.17M for 3 months, ending with a clear go or stop decision.

From Globe, Step 1 needs four things:

- a senior sponsor;
- up to five people from Globe's AI group and IT, if they can be spared, with partners and contractors for the rest (this cuts new spending on Step 1 to about US$0.94M);
- permission to check the care data for privacy, and about 1,000 real care questions with personal details removed;
- early talks with STT GDC Philippines about the small locked space needed from Step 2.

Everything else, such as servers, licensed data and outside audits, comes later and is already counted in the steps above.

10. Words you may not know

Word	What it means
AI model (LLM)	The "brain" behind tools like ChatGPT, which reads and writes text
Open model	An AI model that is free to download, use and train further, within its licence
Training	Teaching a model with examples so it gets better at a language or a job
GPU	A powerful computer chip used to train and run AI
GPU-hour	One GPU running for one hour, the basic unit for pricing AI computing
Person-month	One person working for one month, the unit for pricing people
Data centre	A secure building full of servers, with power and cooling
Router	The part that sends each question to the right model
Gate	A checkpoint where leaders decide whether to release the next amount of money
Payback	The point where the value Luntian has brought equals what has been spent
Taglish	Tagalog and English mixed together, the way many Filipinos speak